Lab 2: Sprint Reflection

Feature Flag & Dynamic Config Manager (Problem Statement #43)

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Sprint summary

Sprint 1 (Core Flag Engine) committed 35 points across 11 work items and finished 30. The one story left open was SCRUM-16, the 10,000-user distribution test, which was still in progress when the sprint closed and moved into Sprint 2.

Sprint 2 (Sync & Audit) committed 41 points: its own 36 plus the 5 carried over. It finished 39. SCRUM-19, the side-by-side environment view, was never started. It is Low priority and was sent back to the backlog.

Across both sprints the team completed 69 of the 71 points in the backlog.

1. Did your estimations reflect the actual effort?

Mostly. The small, well-understood items (input validation at 1 point, the setup tasks at 2 to 3 points) closed quickly and in the order expected. The 5-point items took the longest in Sprint 1, which matches their estimates.

The miss was SCRUM-16. It was rated 5 points, the same as the hash-bucketing story it tests, but it could only start once the rollout and bucketing stories were done, so it ran out of time. The estimate covered the work but not the dependency. Next time a test story that depends on two other stories should either be scheduled after them in the same sprint with slack, or planned for the following sprint from the start.

SCRUM-20 (real-time push, 8 points) was the riskiest item. Splitting it into the push itself, the retry warning (SCRUM-22) and the load test (SCRUM-23) kept each piece small enough to finish inside one sprint.

2. Was your backlog well-prioritized?

Yes. FR-001 to FR-003 are High priority in Lab 1 because a flag platform cannot work without correct evaluation, rollouts and environment separation. Those went into Sprint 1 together with the setup tasks they depend on. Real-time sync and the audit log (FR-004, FR-005, Medium) build on top of that core and went into Sprint 2.

One correction: SCRUM-12 (15 ms latency, NFR-001) is High priority but sat in Sprint 2. That was deliberate, since there is nothing to load-test until evaluation exists, but it shows that priority alone does not decide order. Dependencies matter as much.

The Low-priority items were the right ones to drop. When Sprint 2 ran short, SCRUM-19 went back to the backlog without affecting any requirement's acceptance criteria.

3. How did your simulated sprint align with your plan?

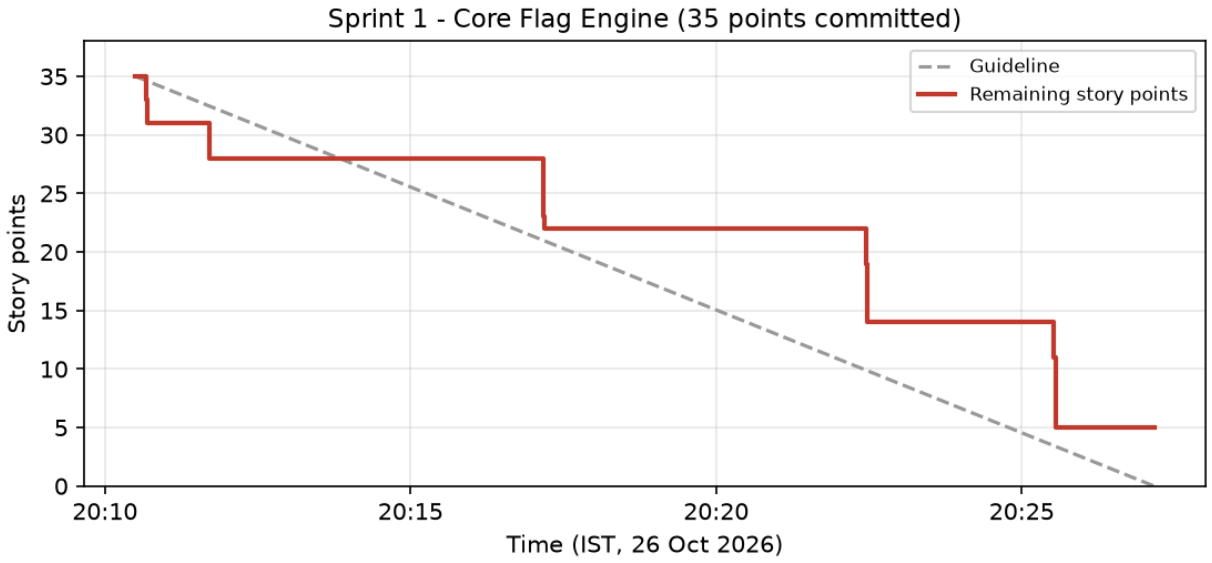
Sprint 1 followed the plan closely: setup first, then evaluation and rollout stories, then environment overrides. Only the carried-over test story broke from it.

Sprint 2 finished everything except the Low-priority view. Because SCRUM-16 was nearly done, it closed almost as soon as Sprint 2 started.

Both sprints were time-boxed to minutes rather than a week, since this was a simulation. That compressed the timeline but kept the order of work and the carry-over behaviour you would see in a real sprint.

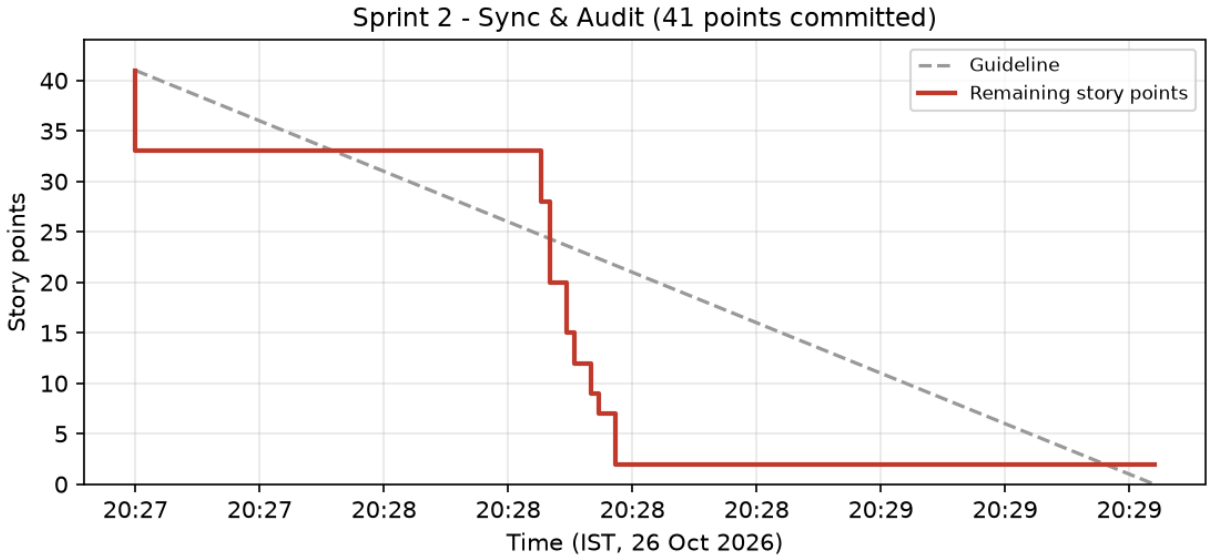
4. What insights did the burndown chart give about your team's capacity?

The charts below are plotted from the exact times each work item moved to Done in Jira. Jira's own Sprint Insights burndown (screenshots 04 and 07) groups progress by day, so a sprint that runs in under an hour shows up as a single straight line there.



Sprint 1 burndown (from Jira status-change timestamps)

Sprint 1 drops in steps that sit close to the guideline, then flattens at 5 points. That flat tail is SCRUM-16. The team delivered about 30 points per sprint, which is a fair figure to plan the next sprint against.



Sprint 2 burndown (from Jira status-change timestamps)

Sprint 2 shows a sharp drop. The handout notes that a sharp drop can mean work was not broken down well. Here it mostly reflects the compressed simulation, with several finished stories closed within a minute of each other. Even so, 41 points was more than the 30 the team showed in Sprint 1, and the sprint ended 2 points short. A safer commitment for the next sprint would be about 30 to 35 points.